
Knowledge, skills and understanding: Papers 1 and 2

Introduction to the Paper 1 options

The relevant pages of this section specify the substantive content that must be taught for the chosen option. All of the content for the option is mandatory.

Each Paper 1 option has two focuses: themes (breadth) and historical interpretations (depth).

The four *themes* focus on developments and changes over a broad timescale. As well as understanding the content, students will need to develop skills necessary to answer questions that target knowledge and understanding of the period (AO1).

In chronological terms, the *historical interpretations* section comes either at the end of the *themes* or runs parallel to them, depending on the option chosen. In either case, the themes provide context for the historical interpretations without duplicating content. As well as understanding the substantive content, students will need to develop skills necessary to answer questions that target the ability to analyse and evaluate historical interpretations (AO3).

Further information about the knowledge, skills and understanding to be assessed can be found in *Appendix 7*.

Introduction to the Paper 2 options

The Paper 2 option must be chosen from the same route as the Paper 1 option, and so the content for the Paper 1 and 2 options are grouped together.

The relevant pages of this section specify the substantive content that must be taught for the chosen option. All of the content for the option is mandatory.

Each Paper 2 option is focused on depth, requiring more detailed knowledge and understanding of the topic, and over a shorter time period, than Paper 1.

The content is organised into four *key topics*. As well as understanding the content, students will need to develop skills necessary to answer questions that target knowledge and understanding of the period (AO1) and questions that target the ability to analyse and evaluate sources (AO2).

Further information about the knowledge, skills and understanding to be assessed can be found in *Appendix 7*.

Route A: Conquest, control and resistance in the medieval world

Overview

Students taking Route A will study:

- *Paper 1, Option 1A: The crusades, c1095–1204*

and **either**:

- *Paper 2, Option 2A.1: Anglo-Saxon England and the Anglo-Norman Kingdom, c1053–1106*

or:

- *Paper 2, Option 2A.2: England and the Angevin Empire in the reign of Henry II, 1154–89.*

The options in Route A are linked by the themes of attempts at conquest and control, which were manifested in different ways, such as invasion, coercion and administrative reforms. They are also linked by resistance to those attempts, for example by conquered peoples, powerful individuals and religious institutions.

Studying two distinct geographical areas will allow students to develop a greater appreciation of the nature of power and royal authority in the medieval world and of similarities and contrasts between them (although students will not be required to answer comparative questions that link the breadth and the chosen depth option).